



YOU ARE PLAYING

Sage Whitfield

*Gala Pianist & Bandleader**“If you can hum it, I can play it, right up to the stroke of twelve.”***FOR SAGE WHITFIELD'S EYES ONLY**

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

A bow tie or velvet, a touch of sequins, and sheet music under one arm.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Bandleader of the Larkhaven Five and tonight's gala pianist. Sage lives in the little flat above the clock shop.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** your landlord and downstairs neighbour
- ◆ **Devon Ashby:** booked your band for tonight
- ◆ **Parker Brightwell:** requests the same song at every party

PAGE 2**Before the game**

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3**Rounds 1 · 2**

Read each only when told

PAGE 4**Round 3 · Notes**

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH

You are innocent. You did not harm Ellis. But you do have something to hide, so tonight you will look suspicious.

Your background

You play piano at every wedding and party in Larkhaven, and you rent the flat above Pendleworth & Co. Clockworks.

YOUR SECRET

You are four months behind on rent. Last week Ellis told you: “Pay by spring, or find another flat.” You also wrote the “Old Lark Waltz” for tonight, and it stung that Ellis’s name appears beside it in the programme.

Your story tonight

You played the piano from 9:00. At 10:00 you led the toast rehearsal at the piano until 10:25.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Keep your rent trouble private
- ◆ Make sure the countdown song is perfect
- ◆ Find out who stopped the music tonight

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



✦ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Hum a few bars of the Old Lark Waltz for anyone who asks.
- ◆ Devon Ashby asked you to start the toast rehearsal at exactly 10:00 and keep everyone there until 10:25.
- ◆ At 9:40 the raffle interrupted your set. Devon was on stage holding the prize box.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Parker Brightwell** which song they want at midnight.
- ◆ Ask **Devon Ashby** why the rehearsal had to start at exactly ten.

YOUR TASK

Get the whole room to practise a ten-second countdown together.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

✦ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Everyone who came to the rehearsal stayed until 10:25. The Mayor sang loudest.
- ◆ One person who promised to come never appeared: Devon Ashby, who said they would bring the punch.
- ◆ If pressed, admit the rent trouble. Ellis was strict, but kind about it.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** whether they will be your new landlord.
- ◆ Ask **Emerson Quill** why they skipped the rehearsal.

YOUR TASK

Find two people who can confirm where they were at 10:10.

Round 3 and notes



✦ Round 3



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Admit the waltz grudge: you wanted credit, not revenge.
- ◆ From the piano at 9:00 you saw Ellis take Harper Lune aside by the workshop door and squeeze Harper's hand.
- ◆ You heard Old Lark strike ten during the rehearsal; nobody left the piano.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** what the workshop sounded like at 10:27.
- ◆ Ask **Reese Calloway** why they looked so rattled when the rehearsal began.

YOUR TASK

Play (or hum) a dramatic “suspect theme” for the person you suspect most.

Notes

Suspects at a glance

Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker

Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City

Harper Lune · The Clockmaker's Long-Lost Relative

Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer

Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower

Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master

Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven

Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger

Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner

Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader

Blair Okafor · Town Historian

Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer